

Spiritual Gems — Week of June 15–21, 2026

Bible reading: Jeremiah 7-8

"What spiritual gems from this week's Bible reading would you like to share?"

15 options. Each ~20–30 sec spoken (≈ 55–75 words). Avoids verses already covered by the Treasures part (Jer 7:4, 7:8-10, 7:11, 7:12-14) and the official Insight question (Jer 8:22).

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 7:3	Jehovah's first reflex is mercy — he opens a door before he closes one
2	Jer 7:5-7	Real worship is measured by how we treat people Jehovah loves
3	Jer 7:16	Jehovah's patience is enormous — but not unlimited
4	Jer 7:17, 18	Families rise — or drift — together
5	Jer 7:19	"It's themselves they hurt" — a Father, not a tyrant
6	Jer 7:21-23	Obedience always mattered more to him than ritual
7	Jer 7:24	Spiritual direction is set by small daily choices
8	Jer 7:25, 26	Jehovah never gives up — he keeps sending the warning
9	Jer 7:31	Jehovah is incapable of the cruelties he is often blamed for
10	Jer 8:4, 5	Falling isn't the problem — staying down is
11	Jer 8:6	A God who <i>listens</i> , not just observes
12	Jer 8:7	Even the stork knows — what about us?
13	Jer 8:11	Flattery only delays the bleeding
14	Jer 8:18, 19	Real ministers feel the burden they carry
15	Jer 8:20	Doors don't stay open forever — the harvest is now

1 • Jeremiah 7:3

"Reform your ways and your actions, and I will let you keep dwelling in this place."

What I love about Jer 7:3 is that Jehovah doesn't open with a sentence — he opens with an invitation. Even when judgment is already at the door, he says, *Reform your ways, and I will let you stay*. It tells me his first reflex is mercy, not punishment. In the ministry, that's exactly the door we keep offering to people.

2 • Jeremiah 7:5-7

*"If you do not oppress any **foreign resident, fatherless child, or widow**, and if you do not shed innocent blood... then I will keep you in this place."*

In Jer 7:5-7, Jehovah lays out the conditions: stop oppressing the foreigner, the fatherless, the widow, stop shedding innocent blood — *then* I will let you live in this land. Notice the standard. To Jehovah, real worship isn't measured by what we do for him at the temple. It's measured by how we treat the people he loves.

3 • Jeremiah 7:16

"Do not pray for this people... for I will not hear you."

Jer 7:16 stopped me cold. Jehovah tells Jeremiah, *"Do not pray for this people."* What does that say about Jehovah? That his patience is enormous — but it isn't unlimited. There comes a point when even intercession is no longer the answer. It's a sobering reminder — and it's why we don't put off our reform until tomorrow. *Today* is the day Jehovah is still listening.

4 • Jeremiah 7:17, 18

*"The **sons gather** the wood, the **fathers light** the fire, and the **women knead** the dough... to make sacrificial cakes to the 'queen of heaven.'"*

What disturbed me about Jer 7:17, 18 is how the family worked together — children gathering the wood, fathers lighting the fire, mothers kneading the dough — all to bake cakes for a false god. Idolatry had become a family activity. It made me appreciate the opposite picture: a family that does *family worship* together rises together. A family that drifts together drifts together.

5 • Jeremiah 7:19

*"Is it **me** they are offending?' declares Jehovah. 'Is it not **themselves**, to their own shame?'"*

Jer 7:19 is one of the most loving verses in the chapter. Jehovah says, *"Is it me they are offending? Is it not themselves, to their own shame?"* He's not focused on his own pride — he's focused on what their wrongdoing is doing to *them*. That's a Father, not a tyrant. In the ministry, we get to tell people: Jehovah's commands aren't about his ego. They're for our good.

6 • Jeremiah 7:21-23

*"I did not speak to them or command them about **burnt offerings**... But this is what I commanded them: '**Obey my voice**.'"*

What struck me about Jer 7:21-23 is what Jehovah said when he brought Israel out of Egypt. He didn't lead with rules about burnt offerings — he led with one thing: *Obey my voice*. Sacrifices were never the heart of his command — obedience was. It tells me Jehovah has never been impressed by religious performance. He wants relationship. That's what we keep offering people — not a religion, but Jehovah himself.

7 • Jeremiah 7:24

*"They kept walking in the **counsels and stubbornness** of their bad heart, and they went backward and not forward."*

Jer 7:24 explains how the nation got to that point. It says they *"kept walking in the counsels and stubbornness of their bad heart."* Notice — it wasn't one big rebellion. It was a slow walk. Counsel by counsel, choice by choice. That reminds me that my spiritual direction isn't decided in dramatic moments. It's decided in small daily decisions. Whose voice am I listening to today?

8 • Jeremiah 7:25, 26

*"I kept sending all my servants the prophets to you, sending them **day after day**."*

Jer 7:25 says Jehovah sent his servants the prophets *"day after day,"* getting up early to send them. Day. After. Day. What does that teach me about Jehovah? He doesn't give up. Even when his people had hardened their necks, he kept sending warnings. That's the model for our ministry — not one or two visits and we're done. We keep going back, because Jehovah keeps going back.

9 • Jeremiah 7:31

"...something I **had not commanded** and that had **never come up in my heart**."

What Jer 7:31 reveals about Jehovah is incredible. He says the burning of children — what the people were doing in the Valley of Hinnom — "*had not come up into my heart*." He couldn't even imagine such a thing. People accuse God of every kind of cruelty, but Jeremiah tells us — that thought never entered Jehovah's mind. He is incapable of the very evils people blame him for.

10 • Jeremiah 8:4, 5

"Will they **fall down and not get up**? If one turns back, will another not return?"

Jer 8:4 asks a piercing question: "*Will they fall down and not get up? If one turns back, will another not return?*" Jehovah is puzzled. A normal person who trips, gets up. A normal person who wanders off, comes back. So why does Israel stay down? It reminds me that Jehovah is more puzzled by our stubbornness than angry at our stumbles. The fall isn't the problem. Staying down is.

11 • Jeremiah 8:6

"**I paid attention and kept listening**; but they were not speaking what was right."

Jer 8:6 shows us a Jehovah we don't always picture. He says, "*I paid attention and kept listening*." He wasn't just observing — he was *listening*. To conversations, complaints, the words his people spoke when they thought no one was hearing. That's the kind of God I want to draw close to. And in the ministry, this gives me confidence — Jehovah is still listening today, to every honest-hearted person we meet.

12 • Jeremiah 8:7

*"Even the **stork** in the heavens knows its appointed times... but my own people do not understand the judgment of Jehovah."*

Jer 8:7 is striking. Jehovah says even the stork in the sky knows when to migrate. The dove, the swift, the swallow — they follow the seasons by instinct. But his own people, he says, do not know the judgment of Jehovah. The birds outperformed them spiritually. It reminded me — we have something far better than instinct. We have Jehovah's voice. The question is whether we're paying attention to it.

13 • Jeremiah 8:11

*"They... heal the breakdown of the daughter of my people **lightly**, saying, '**Peace! Peace!**' when there is no peace."*

Jer 8:11 warns about leaders who treat the wound of God's people *lightly*, saying "Peace! Peace!" when there is no peace. That hits me. It's so tempting in conversations to tell people only what makes them feel good. But real love sometimes means saying the harder thing. In the ministry, I want to be honest. Jehovah's truth heals. Flattery only delays the bleeding.

14 • Jeremiah 8:18, 19

*"**Incurable is my sorrow**, my heart is sick..."*

In Jer 8:18, Jeremiah cries out, "*Incurable is my sorrow, my heart is sick.*" Think about that — the messenger of judgment is heartbroken over the very people he's warning. What an example. The work of warning is never to be done coldly. In the ministry, that's the test of my motive — does my heart hurt for the people in my territory? Or am I just delivering a message?

15 • Jeremiah 8:20

*"The **harvest has passed**, the **summer has ended**; but as for us, we have not been saved!"*

Jer 8:20 is one of the saddest lines in Scripture: *"The harvest has passed, the summer has ended; but as for us, we have not been saved!"* The opportunity came... and went. It reminds me that doors don't stay open forever. In the ministry, that's why we don't wait for "a better time" to start the conversation. The harvest is now.